

★ STAAR RLA Lesson Plans ★

5 Fun & Engaging TEKS-Aligned Lessons

Grades 3–5 | Teach4Texas

⚠️ PREVIEW — Sample pages only

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⚠️ PREVIEW — Full Lesson 1 Sample

Lesson 1: Story Detective 🔍

Grade: 3rd **TEKS:** 3.6F (Make inferences and use evidence), 3.7C (Use text evidence to support response) **Duration:** 60 minutes **Materials:** Mystery passages, "Detective Notebook" sheets, highlighters, anchor chart paper, sticky notes

Learning Objective

I can make inferences about a story using clues from the text and explain my thinking with evidence.

STAAR Connection

Inference questions are the **most common** on STAAR RLA. STAAR 2.0 requires citing specific text evidence in constructed responses.

Warm-Up (8 minutes): "What's the Story?"

Display this paragraph:

She pulled on her rubber boots and grabbed the big yellow umbrella from the hook by the door. Through the window, she could see the puddles forming on the sidewalk. "I hope the flowers are okay," she muttered, picking up the watering can and putting it back in the closet.

Think-Pair-Share:

1. What's the weather like? (Raining — boots, umbrella, puddles)
2. Why did she put the watering can away? (Rain will water the flowers)

3. Where is she probably going? (Outside)

Anchor chart: INFERENCE = Text Clue + What I Already Know

Main Activity (25 minutes): "Mystery Passages"

Phase 1: Guided Practice (10 min) — Read aloud Mystery Passage #1:

Marcus sat on the bench and watched the other kids run onto the field. He looked down at his ankle, wrapped tightly in a bandage. Coach Rivera walked over and handed him a clipboard and pencil. "I need you to keep track of everyone's time for the sprints," Coach said. Marcus forced a smile. "Sure, Coach."

Whole-class detective work:

Clue from the Text	What I Already Know	My Inference
"Watched the other kids run"	If you're watching, you're not playing	Marcus can't participate
"Ankle wrapped in bandage"	Bandages mean injury	Marcus hurt his ankle
"Forced a smile"	"Forced" means not natural	Marcus is disappointed but trying to be positive

Model constructed response: "Marcus is probably feeling disappointed because he can't practice with his team. The text says he 'forced a smile,' which means it wasn't real. He also 'watched the other kids run' instead of joining them."

Phase 2: Partner Detective Work (15 min) — 2 additional mystery passages with Detective Notebooks and STAAR-format constructed response questions.

Lessons 2–5 + all original passages included in the full version...

★ Get the Full Version! ★

STAAR RLA Lesson Plans — All 5 Lessons + Original Passages

Constructed response practice, paired texts, differentiation, and STAAR 2.0 format throughout.

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